JAMES RICHARDSON

Data Scientist

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

I'm a Data Scientist with 8 years of experience building machine learning systems that solve real business problems. I've led teams through the entire lifecycle of data projects, from exploratory analysis to production deployment, with a particular strength in statistical modelling and Python development. I enjoy mentoring junior data scientists and have a track record of translating complex technical work into actionable insights for stakeholders. I'm based in Leeds and actively contribute to open source projects in my spare time.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Senior Data Scientist

DataFlow Solutions Ltd

https://www.dataflow.io

Leeds, United Kingdom

March 2021 - Present

Led the development of a customer churn prediction model that identified at-risk accounts with 87% accuracy, resulting in retention initiatives that saved GBP 1.2M annually. Managed a team of three junior data scientists, conducting code reviews, designing project workflows, and establishing best practices for reproducible research across the organisation. Built an automated ETL pipeline processing 50GB of customer data daily using Apache Airflow and Spark, reducing manual reporting overhead by 40 hours per week. Mentored two graduate hires through their first year, with both being promoted to mid-level analyst roles within 18 months.

Data Scientist

Insight Analytics Group

https://insightanalytics.co

Manchester, United Kingdom

July 2018 - February 2021

Developed a demand forecasting model for a major retail client that improved inventory planning accuracy by 23%, reducing stock waste by GBP 850K over two years. Designed and implemented A/B testing frameworks for eight client projects, delivering statistical analysis and recommendations that informed product decisions affecting millions of users. Created an internal Python library for feature engineering that standardised processes across twelve concurrent projects and reduced model development time by 30%. Presented findings to executive stakeholders monthly, translating statistical concepts into business language that drove C-suite decision making.

Data Analyst

TechVenture Consulting

https://techventure.net

Leeds, United Kingdom

September 2016 - June 2018

Built SQL queries and automated reporting dashboards using Tableau that tracked KPIs for five enterprise clients, eliminating manual spreadsheet work and improving report delivery speed from weekly to real-time. Conducted exploratory data analysis on customer transaction data that uncovered three new revenue opportunities worth GBP 2.5M in potential annual sales. Trained fifteen business analysts on Python fundamentals and pandas, enabling the team to move from Excel-based analysis to programmatic data workflows. Worked with data engineers to design and optimise database schemas for reporting, improving query performance by 60% on high-volume tables.

EDUCATION

BSc Computer Science

University of Leeds

Leeds, United Kingdom

Graduated June 2016

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Programming Languages: Python, R, SQL, Bash

Machine Learning: Scikit-learn, TensorFlow, XGBoost, Statsmodels, Regression, Classification, Time Series Forecasting

Data Engineering: Apache Spark, Airflow, Apache Kafka, PostgreSQL, MySQL

Data Visualisation: Tableau, Matplotlib, Seaborn, Plotly

Cloud Platforms: AWS (S3, EC2, SageMaker), Google Cloud Platform (BigQuery, Dataflow)

Tools and Frameworks: Git, Docker, Jupyter Notebooks, MLflow, scikit-learn pipeline development

Statistical Methods: Hypothesis testing, A/B testing, Bayesian inference, experimental design

PUBLIC REPOSITORIES

jrichardson-ds/customer-churn-prediction

A machine learning project predicting customer churn with ensemble methods and SHAP feature importance analysis.

jrichardson-ds/time-series-forecasting-toolkit

An open source Python library providing utilities for time series data preprocessing, feature engineering, and model evaluation.

jrichardson-ds/ab-testing-framework

A statistical testing framework for designing and analysing A/B experiments with automatic significance calculations and confidence intervals.

jrichardson-ds/sql-optimisation-guide

A comprehensive guide with practical examples for optimising SQL queries on large datasets with performance benchmarks.